FREE CHECKLIST

Paid Family Leave Checklist for New Parents in New York

Check off each step before you submit your Paid Family Leave application to bond with a new baby, a newly adopted child or a foster child.

PFL = Paid Family Leave (paid time off to bond with your child). **DBL** = New York short-term disability (pays while you recover from your own medical condition, including childbirth). **Carrier** = the insurance company that handles your claim.

1. Check that you qualify and plan your dates

- [ ] I've worked for my employer long enough: at least 26 weeks in a row if I work 20 or more hours a week, or 175 days worked if I work fewer than 20 hours a week.
- [ ] My leave starts after my child is born, adopted or placed with me. Bonding leave can't start before the birth.
- [ ] I will take my bonding leave within 12 months after the birth, adoption or foster placement.
- [ ] If I'm giving birth: I know that DBL pays while I recover and PFL pays while I bond with my baby. I can't get both at the same time, so I've picked the dates for each. DBL usually comes first, then PFL.
- [ ] I know there's a combined limit: DBL and PFL together can't add up to more than 26 weeks in any 52-week period.
- [ ] I told my employer about my leave at least 30 days before it starts if I knew ahead of time, or as soon as I could.

2. Gather your documents

- [ ] Form PFL-1, "Request for Paid Family Leave." I filled out my part. My employer fills out their part.
- [ ] Form PFL-2, "Bonding Certification," filled out.
- [ ] Proof of my child's birth, adoption or foster placement. For a birth: a birth certificate or a health care provider's certification. For an adoption: court documents. For foster care: the placement letter. (The PFL-2 packet lists what's accepted.)
- [ ] If I'm the other parent: proof of my relationship to the child, such as a birth certificate, an acknowledgment of parentage or a court order, or proof of marriage or domestic partnership with the birth parent.
- [ ] My employer's name and my start date, for the forms.
- [ ] Any letters I've received from the insurance carrier.

3. Send it in

- [ ] I gave form PFL-1 to my employer to fill out their part. They must return it within 3 business days. If they don't, I can send in my part without it.
- [ ] Before sending, I checked that every section is filled in and signed, with nothing left blank.
- [ ] I sent everything (PFL-1, PFL-2 and proof) to my employer's insurance carrier no later than 30 days after my leave starts.
- [ ] I kept a copy of everything and wrote down the date I sent it.
- [ ] I know the carrier generally has 18 days to approve or deny my claim after it receives my complete request.

4. Double-check before you send

- [ ] Nothing is missing: every form and every piece of proof is included.
- [ ] I used the official forms, PFL-1 and PFL-2. A doctor's note by itself is not an application.
- [ ] My employer's section is completely filled in, with no blanks.
- [ ] My name, dates and signatures are the same on every page.

My key dates

Birth, adoption or placement date: _____

My leave starts: _____

PFL-1 given to my employer: _____

Send to the carrier by (30 days after my leave starts): _____

Want a second set of eyes before you submit?

Free eligibility check and consultation. Email info@nysdbladvisors.com

nysdbladvisors.com

Official forms are free at paidfamilyleave.ny.gov. Rules, amounts and forms change, so confirm details with the official site. Please don't email Social Security numbers or medical records. NYS DBL & PFL Advisors is an independent advisory service, not a law firm, insurance carrier or broker, and is not affiliated with the State of New York or the Workers' Compensation Board. This checklist is general information, not legal advice. Last reviewed November 12, 2026.